Visual directions & place relations

Text and embedded fonts, vector diagrams and writing lines. Read, listen in Chinese OS, cover, recall, write Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin, then practise your Chinese keyboard.



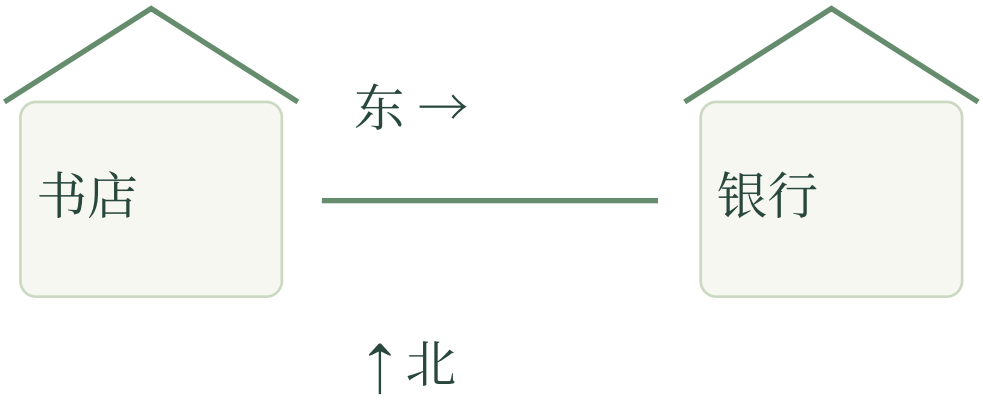
银行在书店东边。

Yínháng zài shūdiàn dōngbian.

The bank is east of the bookshop. North stays at the top; front/back requires a viewer.

Build a location sentence

Keep the buildings fixed. Change which building you describe.



A: locate	在	B: reference	Position
银行 yínháng	在 zài	书店 shūdiàn	东边 dōngbian

A: locate	在	B: reference	Position
书店 shūdiàn	在 zài	银行 yínháng	西边 xībian

书店东边 = 书店的东边

Both mean east of the bookshop. 的 is often optional here.

Turn yourself, not the compass

Facing north ↑

西边 → 左边
xībian → zuǒbian

东边 → 右边
dōngbian → yòubian

北边 → 前边
běibian → qiánbian

南边 → 后边
nánbian → hòubian

Facing south ↓

西边 → 右边
xībian → yòubian

东边 → 左边
dōngbian → zuǒbian

北边 → 后边
běibian → hòubian

南边 → 前边
nánbian → qiánbian

The viewer is at the bottom of the campus map, looking towards the dorms. Buildings 1–2 are in the front row, nearer the viewer; 3–4 are behind. Front/back is not another name for north/south.

Read in meaning groups

请问， 银行 在哪儿?

Qǐngwèn, yínháng zài nǎr?

Excuse me, where is the bank?

银行 在 书店东边。

Yínháng zài shūdiàn dōngbian.

The bank is east of the bookshop.

这 是 什么地方?

Zhè shì shénme dìfang?

What place is this?

哪座楼 是 银行?

Nǎ zuò lóu shì yínháng?

Which building is the bank?

宿舍楼 都在 北边。

Sùshè lóu dōu zài běibian.

The dormitory buildings are all in the north.

Read in meaning groups

一号楼、二号楼 在前边， 三号楼、四号楼 在后边。

Yī hào lóu, èr hào lóu zài qiánbian, sān hào lóu, sì hào lóu zài hòubian.

Buildings 1 and 2 are in front; 3 and 4 are behind.

我的宿舍 在 四号楼。

Wǒ de sùshè zài sì hào lóu.

My dorm room is in Building 4.

一直 往前 走。

Yìzhí wǎng qián zǒu.

Go straight ahead.

到路口 往左 转。

Dào lùkǒu wǎng zuǒ zhuǎn.

At the intersection, turn left.

Related example

书店 在 银行西边。

Shūdiàn zài yínháng xībian.

The bookshop is west of the bank.

Related example

Read in meaning groups

今天 下雨， 我 用雨伞。

Jīntiān xià yǔ, wǒ yòng yǔsǎn.

It is raining today; I use an umbrella.

Related example

我 点了 外卖。

Wǒ diǎn le wàimài.

I ordered food delivery.

Related example

请 找我 十块钱。

Qǐng zhǎo wǒ shí kuài qián.

Please give me ten yuan in change.

Related example

你 很勇敢！

Nǐ hěn yǒnggǎn!

You are brave!

这 是 我们学校。

Zhè shì wǒmen xuéxiào.

This is our school.

Read in meaning groups

东边的 那座楼 是银行。

Dōngbian de nà zuò lóu shì yínháng.

That building on the east side is the bank.

不用。

Bú yòng.

No need.

你 在干嘛?

Nǐ zài gàn má?

What are you doing? (casual)

今天 天气 不好。

Jīntiān tiānqì bù hǎo.

The weather is bad today.

我 不用 出租车。

Wǒ bú yòng chūzūchē.

I do not need a taxi.

Read in meaning groups

银行 在 东边。

Yínháng zài dōngbian.

The bank is to the east.

这是 书店， 东边的那座楼 是银行。

Zhè shì shūdiàn, dōngbian de nà zuò lóu shì yínháng.

This is the bookshop; the building east of it is the bank.

谢谢！ 不客气！

Xièxie! Bú kèqi!

Thank you! You’re welcome!

这是 书店， 那是 银行。

Zhè shì shūdiàn, nà shì yínháng.

This is the bookshop; that is the bank.

那座楼 是四号楼， 我的宿舍 在四号楼。

Nà zuò lóu shì sì hào lóu, wǒ de sùshè zài sì hào lóu.

That is Building 4; my dorm room is in Building 4.

Read in meaning groups

书店 在哪儿?

Shūdiàn zài nǎr?

Where is the bookshop?

学校 在 宿舍南边。

Xuéxiào zài sùshè nánbian.

The school is south of the dormitory.

请问， 银行 在哪里?

Qǐngwèn, yínháng zài nǎlǐ?

Excuse me, where is the bank?

外面 下雨了， 带雨伞吧。

Wàimian xià yǔ le, dài yǔsǎn ba.

It is raining outside; take an umbrella.

我 想 点外卖。

Wǒ xiǎng diǎn wàimài.

I want to order food delivery.

Read in meaning groups

我 在找 我的钱。

Wǒ zài zhǎo wǒ de qián.

I am looking for my money.

外面 下雨了， 我 带雨伞。

Wàimian xià yǔ le, wǒ dài yǔsǎn.

It is raining outside; I take an umbrella.

我 有 两千块钱。

Wǒ yǒu liǎng qiān kuài qián.

I have two thousand yuan.

Vocabulary & related words

东边	dōngbian	east; eastern side
西边	xībian	west; western side
南边	nánbian	south; southern side
北边	běibian	north; northern side
前边	qiánbian	in front; depends on the viewpoint
后边	hòubian	behind; depends on the viewpoint
左边	zuǒbian	left; depends on which way you face
右边	yòubian	right; depends on which way you face
银行	yínháng	bank
书店	shūdiàn	bookshop
学校	xuéxiào	school
宿舍	sùshè	dormitory

Vocabulary & related words

楼	lóu	building; storey
号	hào	number; label for a building
地方	dìfang	place
哪儿	nǎr	where
一座楼	yí zuò lóu	one building
一直	yìzhí	continuously; straight on in a route
往	wǎng	towards; in the direction of
走	zǒu	walk; go on foot
左转	zuǒ zhuǎn	turn left
右转	yòu zhuǎn	turn right
路口	lùkǒu	intersection
下雨	xià yǔ	rain; be raining

Vocabulary & related words

雨伞	yǔsǎn	umbrella
外卖	wàimài	takeaway; food delivery
钱	qián	money
千	qiān	thousand
找	zhǎo	look for; give change
用	yòng	use
勇敢	yǒnggǎn	brave
祈祷	qídǎo	pray
在	zài	be at; located at
哪里	nǎlǐ	where (variant of 哪儿)
两千	liǎng qiān	two thousand
找到	zhǎo dào	find; successfully locate

Vocabulary & related words

带	dài	bring; take along
点外卖	diǎn wàimài	order food delivery

Write Hanzi + tone-marked Pinyin

Trace once, then write both systems four times. Cover the model for the final attempts. Scroll outside the writing boxes when using Apple Pencil.

东边 dōngbian · east; eastern side

东边 dōngbian				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

西边 xībian · west; western side

西边 xībian				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

南边 nánbian · south; southern side

南边 nánbian				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

北边 běibian · north; northern side

北边 běibian				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

Write Hanzi + tone-marked Pinyin

Trace once, then write both systems four times. Cover the model for the final attempts. Scroll outside the writing boxes when using Apple Pencil.

前边 qiánbian · in front; depends on the viewpoint

前边 qiánbian				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

后边 hòubian · behind; depends on the viewpoint

后边 hòubian				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

左边 zuǒbian · left; depends on which way you face

左边 zuǒbian				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

右边 yòubian · right; depends on which way you face

右边 yòubian				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

Write Hanzi + tone-marked Pinyin

Trace once, then write both systems four times. Cover the model for the final attempts. Scroll outside the writing boxes when using Apple Pencil.

银行 yínháng · bank

银行 yínháng				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

书店 shūdiàn · bookshop

书店 shūdiàn				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

学校 xuéxiào · school

学校 xuéxiào				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

宿舍 sùshè · dormitory

宿舍 sùshè				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

Write Hanzi + tone-marked Pinyin

Trace once, then write both systems four times. Cover the model for the final attempts. Scroll outside the writing boxes when using Apple Pencil.

楼 lóu · building; storey

楼 lóu				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

号 hào · number; label for a building

号 hào				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

地方 dìfang · place

地方 dìfang				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

哪儿 nǎr · where

哪儿 nǎr				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

Write Hanzi + tone-marked Pinyin

Trace once, then write both systems four times. Cover the model for the final attempts. Scroll outside the writing boxes when using Apple Pencil.

一座楼 yí zuò lóu · one building

一座楼
yí zuò lóu

1 TRACE | 2 WRITE | 3 WRITE | 4 WRITE | 5 WRITE

在 zài · be at; located at

在
zài

1 TRACE | 2 WRITE | 3 WRITE | 4 WRITE | 5 WRITE

哪里 nǎlǐ · where (variant of 哪儿)

哪里
nǎlǐ

1 TRACE | 2 WRITE | 3 WRITE | 4 WRITE | 5 WRITE

下雨 xià yǔ · rain; be raining

下雨
xià yǔ

1 TRACE | 2 WRITE | 3 WRITE | 4 WRITE | 5 WRITE

Write Hanzi + tone-marked Pinyin

Trace once, then write both systems four times. Cover the model for the final attempts. Scroll outside the writing boxes when using Apple Pencil.

雨伞 yǔsǎn · umbrella

雨伞 yǔsǎn				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

外卖 wàimài · takeaway; food delivery

外卖 wàimài				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

钱 qián · money

钱 qián				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

找 zhǎo · look for; give change

找 zhǎo				
1 TRACE	2 WRITE	3 WRITE	4 WRITE	5 WRITE

Write Hanzi + tone-marked Pinyin

Trace once, then write both systems four times. Cover the model for the final attempts. Scroll outside the writing boxes when using Apple Pencil.

两千 liǎng qiān · two thousand

两千
liǎng qiān

1 TRACE | 2 WRITE | 3 WRITE | 4 WRITE | 5 WRITE

找到 zhǎo dào · find; successfully locate

找到
zhǎo dào

1 TRACE | 2 WRITE | 3 WRITE | 4 WRITE | 5 WRITE

千 qiān · thousand

千
qiān

1 TRACE | 2 WRITE | 3 WRITE | 4 WRITE | 5 WRITE

Recall both directions

Write Pinyin with tones for the first four items. Write Hanzi for the next four. Check the vocabulary only after your attempt.

东边

前边

银行

钱

xībian

sùshè

liǎng qiān

nǎlǐ

Chinese keyboard / IME

On your Chinese keyboard, type the Pinyin letters WITHOUT tones. Select the Hanzi that matches the context. Handwritten Pinyin practice still needs the correct tone marks.

1. qian · money
前 / 钱 / 千

2. qian · thousand
钱 / 千 / 前

3. zhao · look for
找 / 我 / 钱

4. zuo · classifier for a building
坐 / 座 / 做

5. zai · be located at
在 / 再 / 才

Build the sentence

Put the meaning groups in natural Chinese order. Write the complete sentence and its tone-marked Pinyin.

在 / 书店东边。 / 银行

在 / 宿舍南边。 / 学校

银行 / 在哪儿？ / 请问，

Check after practising

IME
钱 · 千 · 找 · 座 · 在

1. 银行在书店东边。
Yínháng zài shūdiàn dōngbian.
The bank is east of the bookshop.

2. 学校在宿舍南边。
Xuéxiào zài sùshè nánbian.
The school is south of the dormitory.

3. 请问，银行在哪儿?
Qǐngwèn, yínháng zài nǎr?
Excuse me, where is the bank?